

RAÍCES

Additional Resources

How to Have a Devotional Time: A Guide for New Believers

You already learned about prayer and reading the Word as spiritual disciplines in your RAÍCES journey. A devotional time brings both together into one daily, personal time with God. This guide shows you how to structure it, step by step.

Psalms 119:105 (NLT): "Your word is a lamp to guide my feet and a light for my path."

What is a devotional time?

It's personal time you set aside each day to seek God: to worship Him, praise Him, read His Word, reflect on it, pray, and put it into practice. It's not a religious obligation — it's a daily appointment with Someone who wants to speak to you.

The 7 steps of a devotional time

1. Praise God

Start by recognizing who God is. You can listen to or sing a praise song, and thank Him for His goodness, His faithfulness, and His mercy.

Psalms 100:4 (NLT): "Enter his gates with thanksgiving; go into his courts with praise. Give thanks to him and praise his name."

Question: What can I thank God for today?

2. Worship

Take a few moments to express your love, reverence, and surrender to God. Worship isn't just singing — it's recognizing who God is and giving Him your life. You can say something as simple as: "Lord, You are worthy of all my worship. I give You this day and my life."

3. Read the Word

Choose a short passage and read it slowly. To start, 5 to 10 verses is enough.

4. Reflect

Ask yourself: What does this passage say? What does it teach me about God? What does God want to teach me today? Is there something I need to change or obey?

5. Write

Write down one truth God showed you, even if it's just one sentence: "Today God taught me that..."

6. Pray

Talk to God about what you read. You can pray for your spiritual life, your family, your needs, other people, and ask for strength to obey what you just read.

7. Apply

Ask yourself: What am I going to put into practice today? The goal isn't just to read the Word, but to live it out.

James 1:22 (NLT): *"But don't just listen to God's word. You must do what it says. Otherwise, you are only fooling yourselves."*

Example of a 20-30 minute devotional time

- 5 minutes — Praise and worship
- 10 minutes — Bible reading and reflection
- 5 minutes — Writing down what you learned
- 5 to 10 minutes — Prayer and commitment to apply it

You don't have to hit these exact minutes from day one. If you only have 10 minutes available, use them — a short, consistent devotional time is worth more than a long one you never actually do.

A FORMULA TO REMEMBER PRAISE — WORSHIP — READ — REFLECT — WRITE — PRAY — APPLY

The main truth

A devotional time is a daily encounter with God, where you praise Him, worship Him, listen to His Word, talk with Him, and let Him transform your life one day at a time.